

THE JAMREADY ROADMAP

1. GROOVE FIRST

Become someone other musicians can trust to keep time.

- Play quarter notes with a metronome for 3 min. at the same tempo
- Practice with a drum groove at various tempos
- Record yourself and listen for rushing or dragging
- Learn one bass line from a favorite song, focus on matching the feel
- Practice playing simple grooves at slow, medium, and fast tempos

Checkpoint: Can you hold a steady groove for an entire song?

3. BUILD VOCABULARY

Bank reusable musical ideas to create your own bass lines.

- Learn five bass lines from songs you love
- Learn one groove from each of these genres: funk, blues, rock
- Learn one walking bass pattern
- Identify what these bass lines have in common

Checkpoint: Can you create a basic groove over a simple chord progression?

5. DEVELOP ENSEMBLE SKILLS

Become a musician others enjoy playing with.

- Practice playing softer and louder intentionally
- Leave space between phrases
- Listen to the drummer's kick pattern
- Practice locking in with a drum groove
- Record yourself and ask: "Am I supporting the music?"

Checkpoint: Do other musicians find it easy to play with you?

2. UNDERSTAND THE HARMONY

Know where the music is going.

- Learn the major scale formula, find E- and A-string root notes
- Play a I-IV-V progression in at least three keys
- Practice with a drum groove instead of only a metronome
- Learn a 12-bar blues
- Practice playing root notes along with simple songs

Checkpoint: Can you follow a chord progression using root notes alone?

4. TRAIN YOUR EARS

Hear what is happening and react musically.

- Learn one song by ear each week
- Practice finding roots by ear
- Sing rhythms before playing them
- Learn to recognize when the chord changes

Checkpoint: Can you figure out a simple bass line without tabs?

6. START JAMMING

Apply your skills in real musical situations.

- Play with another musician once this month
- Attend a local jam session
- Use backing tracks in different styles
- Learn three songs that are commonly called at jams
- Keep a list of songs you can confidently play

Checkpoint: Have you played music with another person in the last 30 days?

THE JAMREADY TEST

Give yourself one point for each statement:

- ☐ I can keep steady time.
- ☐ I can play a 12-bar blues.
- ☐ I know my root notes.
- ☐ I can learn songs by ear.
- ☐ I can create simple bass lines.

- ☐ I can lock in with a drummer.
- ☐ I can play dynamically.
- ☐ I know songs I can call at a jam.
- ☐ I have played with another musician recently.
- ☐ I feel comfortable joining a beginner-friendly jam.

0-3 Points: Build your foundation.

4-7 Points: You're getting close.

8-10 Points: You're JamReady.

Want Help Getting There?

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